

augmentation of trains and tracks. To execute this, it has announced a capex of ₹54 lakh crore by 2030. The Railways will focus on increasing earnings from freight, and will connect more destinations with the semi-high-speed Vande Bharat trains.

The plan is to increase Vande Bharat trains from the current 100 to 800 by 2030 and 4,500 by 2047. Plus, work is underway on rolling out Vande Bharat metro trains on suburban sections. That implies a huge investment, as the manufacturing cost of a 16-coach Vande Bharat train is roughly around ₹100 crore, compared to ₹50 crore for a 22-coach German-designed Linke-Hofmann-Busch train, which is the more conventional model.

There will also be renewed focus on the non-AC component of the passenger segment. The Railways ferried around 58.5 billion passengers in FY23, and about 95% of earnings in the passenger segment come from the non-AC segment.

The government has announced the introduction of 50 superfast Amrit Bharat trains in FY25 to enhance passenger experience on non-Vande Bharat routes.

The Railways is also looking to revive attempts to partner with private players to redevelop stations, despite facing setbacks in these efforts in the past few years. The decongestion of high-density routes connecting metros with multiple tracks is also being worked out.

But perhaps the prestige



THE ROAD MAP

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RAILWAYS

- **50,000 km of new tracks to be built in the next 10 years**
- **Revamping of 40,000 bogies**
- **800 new Vande Bharat trains to be introduced by 2030**
- **Station redevelopment to be taken up, and measures to increase freight share**



HIGHWAYS

- **Target is to build 50,000 km of high-speed access control highways by 2047**
- **Raising daily highway construction to 40 km per day**
- **Increase private investment in the road sector**
- **Push for electric vehicles and advanced technology**



AVIATION

- **Construct 200 more airports in the next five years**
- **Expand the ambit of the UDAN scheme**
- **More airports owned by AAI will be privatised through public-private partnerships**
- **Airport modernisation to develop aviation hubs**

PROPOSED HIGH SPEED RAIL CORRIDORS

- **Delhi-Varanasi HSR (942 km)** —including spur of 124 km from Lucknow to Ayodhya
- **Mumbai-Nagpur HSR (765 km)**
- **Mumbai-Hyderabad HSR (671 km)**
- **Chennai-Mysuru HSR (451 km)**
- **Delhi-Amritsar HSR (476 km)**
- **Varanasi-Howrah HSR (752 km)**